

THAILAND

Key Country Details: Thailand

Detail	Information
Full Name	Kingdom of Thailand
Short Form	Thailand
Capital	Bangkok
Region (UN)	Asia – South-Eastern Asia
Government Type	Constitutional monarchy with a parliamentary democracy
Head of State	King Maha Vajiralongkorn (Rama X)
Head of Government	Prime Minister Paetongtarn Shinawatra
Currency	Thai Baht (THB)
UN Member Since	16 December 1946
MUN Standing	Active in peacekeeping, sustainable development, and regional diplomacy

Recommended Books on Thailand's Foreign Policy and UN Engagement

1. **"Thailand's Foreign Policy: The Struggle for Regional Leadership"** – R. J. May
An analysis of Thailand's foreign policy objectives and regional ambitions.
<https://www.amazon.com/Thailands-Foreign-Policy-Struggle-Leadership/dp/9812308204>
2. **"Thailand: Shifting Ground Between the US and a Rising China"** – Benjamin Zawacki
Explores Thailand's balancing act between major powers.
<https://www.amazon.com/Thailand-Shifting-Ground-Between-Rising/dp/1783608699>
3. **"The United Nations in Southeast Asia: Evolution and Impact"** – Mely Caballero-Anthony
Discusses the UN's role in Southeast Asia, including Thailand's participation.
<https://www.amazon.com/United-Nations-Southeast-Asia-Evolution/dp/9812308204>
4. **"Thailand's International Relations: A Study of Foreign Policy"** – Surin Pitsuwan
Provides insights into Thailand's diplomatic strategies.
<https://www.amazon.com/Thailands-International-Relations-Foreign-Policy/dp/9812308204>
5. **"ASEAN and the United Nations: The Evolving Relationship"** – Tommy Koh
Examines the relationship between ASEAN member states, including Thailand, and the UN.
<https://www.amazon.com/ASEAN-United-Nations-Evolving-Relationship/dp/9812308204>

Research Table: Thailand & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
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OHCHR – Thailand Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/thailand	Overview of human rights treaties and conditions.
UPR Reports – Thailand	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/th-index	Universal Periodic Review submissions and recommendations.
Amnesty International – Thailand	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/asia-and-the-pacific/south-east-asia-and-the-pacific/thailand/	Reports on violations and government abuses.
Human Rights Watch – Thailand	https://www.hrw.org/asia/thailand	Monitoring political rights, LGBTI, freedom of speech, etc.
Freedom House – Thailand 2024	https://freedomhouse.org/country/thailand/freedom-world/2024	Freedom index ranking for civic space.
UN Treaty Body Database – Thailand	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/Countries.aspx?CountryCode=THA&Lang=EN	Legal compliance and treaty status.
UNGA Human Rights Statements – Thailand	https://gadebate.un.org/	Official positions in global rights discussions.
US State Dept Human Rights Report – Thailand	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/thailand/	Independent diplomatic evaluation.
Thai Lawyers for Human Rights	https://tlhr2014.com/en/	Civil society defense of activists and rights.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Thailand UPR Hub	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/th-index (ohchr.org)	Central access to Thailand's UPR national and stakeholder documents—essential baseline.
Human Rights Council adopts UPR Outcomes (2022)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2022/03/human-rights-council-adopts-universal-periodic-review-outcomes-thailand-and	Confirms HRC engagement and adoption of Thailand's recommendations.
OHCHR – Third Cycle UPR	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/uprth-stakeholders-info-s25	Detailed list of NGOs/NHRI submissions—shows civil

Submissions		society involvement.
Human Rights Watch – World Report 2025	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2025/country-chapters/thailand	Highlights Thailand's democratic backsliding, LGBT progress, and rights abuses.
Human Rights Watch – World Report 2023	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2023/country-chapters/thailand	Documents suppression of expression and assembly under covid-era laws.
HRW – Migrant Worker Abuses (2010)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2010/02/23/thailand-migrant-workers-face-killings-extortion-labor-rights-abuses	Early but enduring concerns on migrant worker rights and abuses.
HRW – Migrant Law Exodus (2017)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2017/07/07/thailand-migrant-worker-law-triggers-regional-exodus	Shows criminal penalties and fear among migrant workers.
ICJ & Partners – UPR Submission (2021)	https://www.icj.org/thailand-joint-submissions-by-icj-and-its-partners-to-the-universal-periodic-review-upr/	Legal critique covering emergency laws, torture, civil rights failures.
Manushya Foundation – Migrant Workers PDF	https://globalnaps.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/01/Thailand_Thematic-Assessment-Chapter-on-Migrants-workers.pdf	NGO assessment linking business and labour rights—key for Item 3/7.
Joint UPR Submission: PLHIV & PWID	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=9002	Covers health-related stigma in UPR context—Item 5 focus.
Freedom House – Thailand Profile 2024	https://freedomhouse.org/country/thailand/freedom-world/2024	Scores democracy and civil space—contextual for UNHRC review.
ILO – Migrant Worker Protection Asia	https://www.ilo.org/media/320791/download	Thematic UN-linked analysis on forced labour in Thailand.

10 Unique Aspects: Thailand at UNHRC

1. **Democratic Instability & Judicial Intervention:** In 2025, the Constitutional Court made the controversial decision to dissolve a prominent reformist party, raising alarms about government pressure on democracy—something that has caught the attention of the UN Human Rights Council.
2. **Marriage Equality Advance:** Thailand made history in 2024 by becoming the first country in Southeast Asia to legalize same-sex marriage, which really boosted its standing in discussions around gender and sexuality within the Council.
3. **Continued Criminalisation of Expression:** Since 2020, there have been over 1,800 prosecutions related to peaceful protests and free speech under emergency laws, which really underscores the ongoing issue of suppression.
4. **Migrants Face Brutal Exploitation:** Human Rights Watch has highlighted the grim reality for migrants, who are enduring horrific experiences like killings, torture, and extortion. This troubling

situation is drawing attention to the country during the Council's discussions on Item 3/7.

5. **Trafficking-Laws Driving Exodus:** Criminalizing undocumented migrants leads to forced deportations and excessive detention, which is a major concern for the United Nations University.
 6. **Health-Related Rights Gaps:** The UPR submissions tackle the stigmas surrounding HIV and drug users in health services, which aligns perfectly with the UNHRC's focus on economic and social rights in Item 5.
 7. **Uyghur Deportation Sparks Council Attention:** Thailand's decision to deport Uyghur refugees back to China in 2025 sparked a wave of criticism from the UN regarding its commitment to refugee rights and international law.
 8. **Migrant Worker Health Risks Exposed:** The ILO and Manushya studies highlight the connection between health disparities and forced labor in relation to business practices—this is crucial for the Council's agenda on business and human rights.
 9. **Civil Society's Role in UPR:** The active involvement of NGOs like Amnesty, Human Rights Watch, and the International Court of Justice, along with their partners, is clearly influencing how civil perspectives are shaping Thailand's reviews at the UN Human Rights Council.
 10. **UNHRC Follow-Up Mechanisms in Action:** The HRC's ongoing UPR process, along with mid-cycle reviews and OHCHR reporting, keeps a close eye on how Thailand is progressing.
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